

GENERAL ENGLISH (NIMCET STANDARD)

ResourceOS

TOPIC: NOUN • HARD LEVEL (SET 1) / ADVANCED NOUN SYNTAX & SEMANTIC SHIFTS (30 QUESTIONS)

DIRECTIONS (Q.1 – Q.30)

Analyze the underlined noun or construction for subtle semantic differences in singular vs. plural forms, double possessive cases, cognate/adverbial accusatives, and complex agreement rules.

1. He lost his customs at the checkpoint. What does customs mean in this context?

- (A) Habits or traditions
- (B) Duties on imported goods / Government department
- (C) Customer relations
- (D) Etiquettes

2. Contrast good vs. goods. "The truck was carrying heavy ____."

- (A) good
- (B) goods
- (C) goodness
- (D) goodly

3. What is the precise distinction between force and forces?

- (A) Force = strength; Forces = armed troops
- (B) Force = troops; Forces = strength
- (C) Both mean physical strength
- (D) Both mean military units

4. "He took great ____ to complete the assignment."

- (A) pain
- (B) pains
- (C) painful
- (D) pining

5. What does the noun irons mean in: "The prisoner was bound in irons"?

- (A) Pressing irons
- (B) Fetters or chains
- (C) Iron ores
- (D) Metallic elements

6. Identify the double possessive construction: "He is a friend of ____."

- (A) my father
- (B) my father's
- (C) my fathers
- (D) me father

7. In "He slept a sound sleep", what is the function of sleep?

- (A) Direct Object
- (B) Cognate Object
- (C) Adverbial Noun
- (D) Subject Complement

8. In "He walked ten miles", ten miles functions as:

- (A) Direct Object
- (B) Adverbial Accusative / Adverbial Noun
- (C) Indirect Object
- (D) Cognate Object

9. Identify the correct plural of the compound noun looker-on.

- (A) Looker-ons
- (B) Lookers-on
- (C) Lookers-ons
- (D) Looker-on

10. Identify the correct plural of knight-errant.

- (A) Knight-errants
- (B) Knights-errant
- (C) Knights-errants
- (D) Knight-errant

11. Identify the correct plural of major-general.

- | | |
|---------------------|--------------------|
| (A) Majors-general | (B) Major-generals |
| (C) Majors-generals | (D) Major-general |

12. Identify the correct plural of man-servant.

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|------------------|-------------------|
| (A) Man-servants | (B) Men-servants |
| (C) Men-servant | (D) Mans-servants |

13. What is the meaning of sands in "The sands of the desert stretched for miles"?

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|--------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| (A) Tiny grains of stone | (B) A tract of sand / Desert land |
| (C) Hourglass sand | (D) Sand dunes only |

14. What is the meaning of waters in "The ships navigated international waters"?

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|-----------------------------|---|
| (A) Liquid molecules | (B) Seas, oceans, or territorial boundaries |
| (C) Drinking water supplies | (D) Rainwater |

15. Analyze: "His mathematics ____ weak."

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|---------|--------------|
| (A) is | (B) are |
| (C) was | (D) has been |

16. Analyze: "Mathematics ____ an exact science."

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| (A) is | (B) are |
| (C) were | (D) have been |

17. "The statistics of the study ____ proved wrong." (Here statistics refers to data/facts)

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|--------------|---------------|
| (A) has been | (B) have been |
| (C) is | (D) was |

18. "Statistics ____ a branch of applied mathematics."

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|----------|---------------|
| (A) is | (B) are |
| (C) were | (D) have been |

19. Choose the correct possessive form for hyphenated compound titles.

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|------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| (A) The Commander's-in-chief order | (B) The Commander-in-chief's order |
| (C) The Commander-in-chiefs order | (D) The Commanders-in-chief order |

20. "His means ____ small, but he spends wisely."

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|---------|--------------|
| (A) is | (B) are |
| (C) was | (D) has been |

21. "This is the only means available to achieve our goal." Here means is:

- (A) Singular Noun (B) Plural Noun
(C) Verb (D) Adjective

22. What is the difference between brother plurals: brothers vs. brethren?

- (A) Brothers = blood relatives; Brethren = members of a community (B) Brethren = blood relatives; Brothers = community
(C) Both mean blood relatives (D) Brethren is an archaic word with no distinct meaning

23. What is the difference between cloths and clothes?

- (A) Cloths = pieces of fabric; Clothes = garments (B) Clothes = pieces of fabric; Cloths = garments
(C) Both mean garments (D) Cloths is singular, clothes is plural

24. What is the plural of genius when referring to highly talented persons?

- (A) Genii (B) Geniuses
(C) Geniae (D) Genius

25. What is the plural of genius when referring to guardian spirits?

- (A) Geniuses (B) Genii
(C) Genium (D) Genia

26. Spot the error: "I visited (A) / John's and Mary's house (B) / and found the door (C) / locked. (D)" (They live together)

- (A) Part A (B) Part B
(C) Part C (D) Part D

27. Spot the error: "For conscience's sake, (A) / he confessed (B) / his crime (C) / to the police. (D)"

- (A) Part A (B) Part B
(C) Part C (D) No error (Conscience' sake is standard)

28. Identify the correct expression for possessive ending with an 's' sound in classical/idiomatic context:

- (A) For goodness's sake (B) For goodness' sake
(C) For goodness sake (D) For goodnesses sake

29. "The alms _____ distributed among the poor."

- (A) was (B) were
(C) is (D) has been

30. "His riches _____ wings and fly away."

- (A) has (B) have
(C) is having (D) was having

ANSWER KEY (Q1 – Q30)

Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans
1	(B)	6	(B)	11	(B)	16	(A)	21	(A)	26	(B)
2	(B)	7	(B)	12	(B)	17	(B)	22	(A)	27	(A)
3	(A)	8	(B)	13	(B)	18	(A)	23	(A)	28	(B)
4	(B)	9	(B)	14	(B)	19	(B)	24	(B)	29	(B)
5	(B)	10	(B)	15	(B)	20	(B)	25	(B)	30	(B)